

Draw-to-Web

User Manual

Version 0.2.0

Build modern, responsive web pages visually — no code required.

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1. Introduction

Draw-to-Web is a desktop application for building modern, responsive web pages by arranging them on a canvas — no coding required. You compose a page out of visual building blocks, style them with simple controls, and the application produces clean, standards-based website files for you.

1.1 What you can do

- Lay out a page visually by dragging in sections, components, and basic elements.
- Style everything with friendly controls for layout, spacing, color, and text.
- Reuse a single set of design values (called “tokens”) so colors and sizes stay consistent.
- Design for different screen sizes — desktop, tablet, and mobile — from one project.
- Add interactive touches such as hover effects and scroll animations.
- Check your page against built-in accessibility rules before you publish.
- Export a complete website (HTML, CSS, and JavaScript) packaged in a single ZIP file.

1.2 Who it is for

Draw-to-Web is designed for anyone who wants to build a polished web page without writing code: designers, small-business owners, students, and hobbyists. No prior web-development experience is needed.

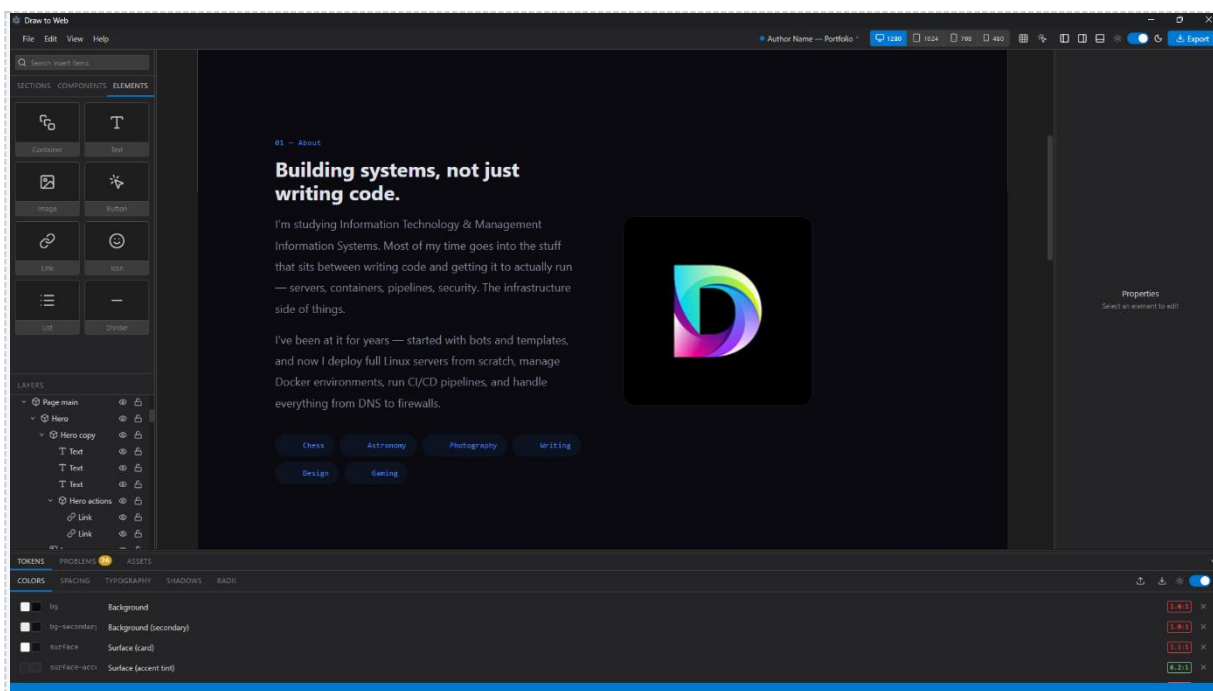


Figure 1. The Draw-to-Web main window with a project open

2. Getting Started

2.1 Installing and launching

1. Obtain the Draw-to-Web installer for your operating system (Windows, macOS, or Linux).
2. Run the installer and follow the on-screen prompts.

3. Launch Draw-to-Web from your Start menu, Applications folder, or desktop shortcut.

Note: The application runs entirely on your computer. Your projects and exported sites are stored locally; nothing is uploaded to the internet.

2.2 Your first project (quick walkthrough)

When the application opens with no project, the Welcome screen appears.

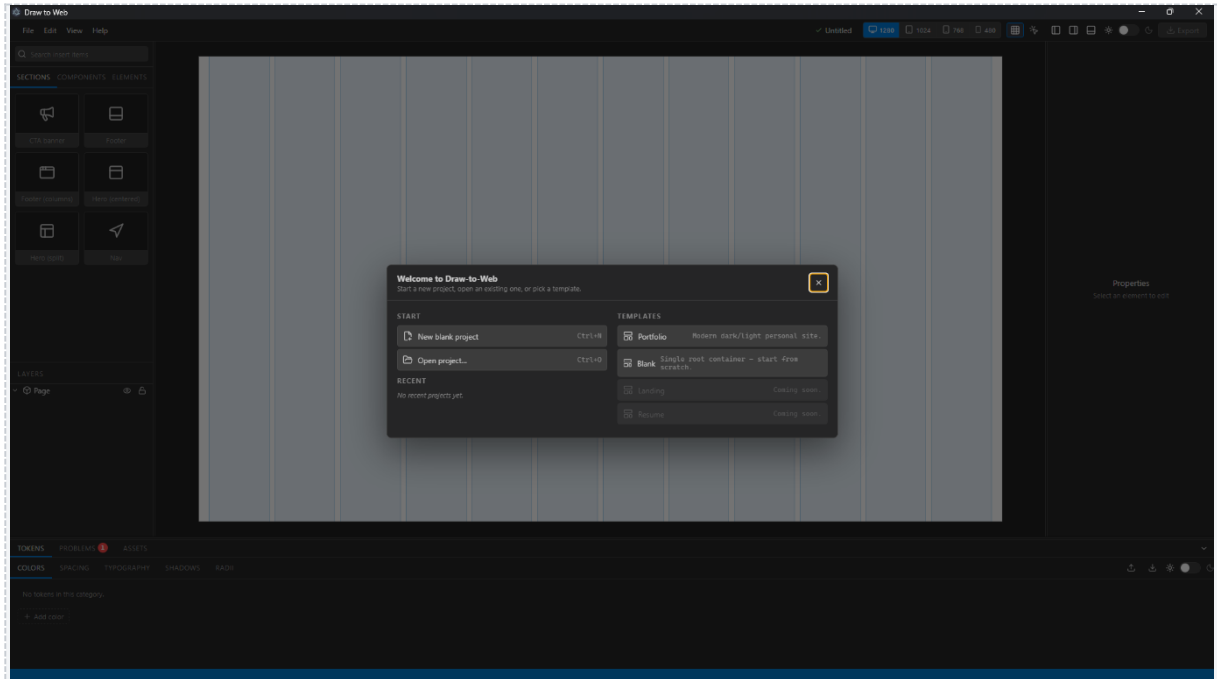


Figure 2. The Welcome screen — Start, Recent, and Templates

1. **Start from a template.** In the Welcome screen, click the Portfolio template to load a ready-made page you can edit. (Or click “New blank project” to start from an empty page.)
2. **Add an element.** In the left sidebar, open the Elements tab and drag a Text block onto the canvas.
3. **Edit it.** Double-click the text to type your own words, then click elsewhere to finish.
4. **Change its look.** With the element selected, use the Properties panel on the right to adjust colour, size, and spacing.
5. **Save your work.** Press Ctrl+S and choose where to store the project file.
6. **Export the site.** Click the Export button in the top-right corner, confirm the options, and the application produces a ZIP file containing your finished website.

3. The Interface

The Draw-to-Web window is divided into five main areas, described below.

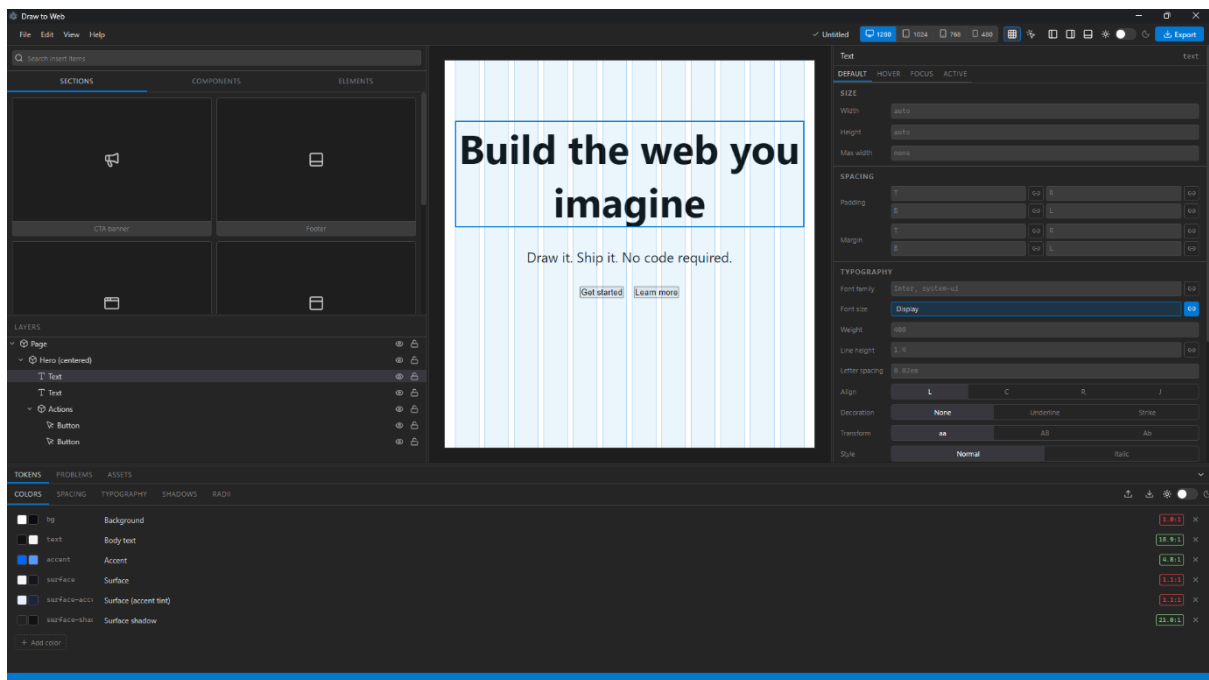


Figure 3. Labelled overview of the interface: menu bar/toolbar, sidebar, canvas, properties, and bottom panel

3.1 The toolbar (top bar)

Running across the top of the window, the toolbar contains:

- **Menus** — File, Edit, View, and Help.
- **Save indicator** — shows the project name. A dot or asterisk appears while you have unsaved changes; click it (or press Ctrl+S) to save.
- **Breakpoint switcher** — Desktop, Tablet, Mobile, and Small buttons that change which screen size you are designing for.
- **Canvas view toggles** — a grid-overlay button and a hover-preview button.
- **Panel toggles** — show or hide the Layers, Properties, and bottom panels.
- **Theme toggle** — switch the preview between light and dark.
- **Export button** — builds your website files.

3.2 The sidebar (left)

The left sidebar has two stacked areas:

- **Insert** — three tabs (Sections, Components, Elements) holding the building blocks you drag onto the page. A search box at the top filters them.
- **Layers** — a tree view of everything on your page, used to select, rename, hide, and lock items.

3.3 The canvas (center)

The canvas is your live page. You select, move, resize, and edit elements here, and it always shows how the page currently looks at the chosen screen size and theme.

3.4 The Properties panel (right)

When you select an element, the Properties panel shows controls for it — layout, size, spacing, typography, color, images, animation, and more. It is the main place you change how things look.

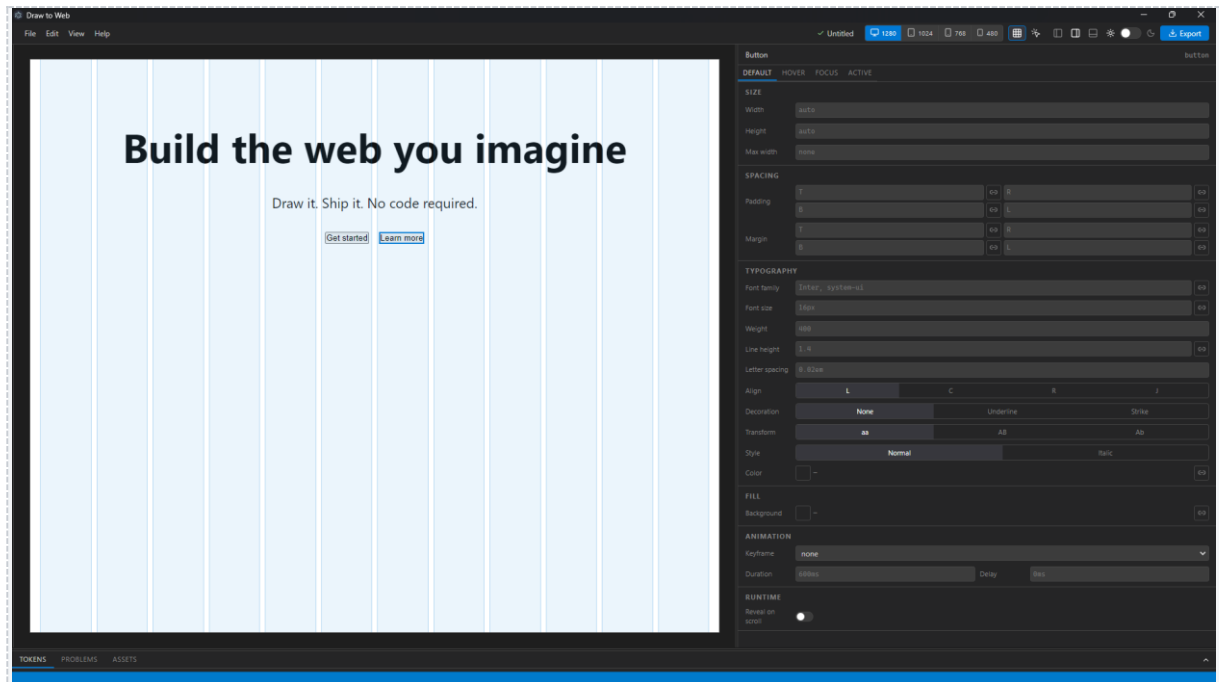


Figure 4. The Properties Panel for a selected element

3.5 The bottom panel

The collapsible panel along the bottom has three tabs:

- **Tokens** — your reusable colors, spacing, typography, shadows, and radii.
- **Problems** — a live list of issues found in your page, such as missing image descriptions.
- **Assets** — the images you have uploaded.

4. Feature-by-Feature Guide

4.1 Starting, opening, and saving projects

Start a new project

1. Open the File menu and choose New (or press Ctrl+N).
2. A fresh, empty page replaces the current one.

Open an existing project

1. Open the File menu and choose Open... (or press Ctrl+O).
2. Select a Draw-to-Web project file (ending in .dtw) and confirm.

Use a template

1. From the Welcome screen, click a template (Portfolio or Blank).
2. The template loads as a new, editable page. (Landing and Resume templates are marked "Coming soon".)

Save your project

1. Press Ctrl+S, or click the project name in the toolbar.
2. Choose a location and filename the first time; later saves overwrite the same file.

Recent projects: The Welcome screen lists projects you opened recently — click one to reopen it quickly.

Automatic backup: While you work, the application periodically writes a backup copy alongside your project so little is lost if the app closes unexpectedly.

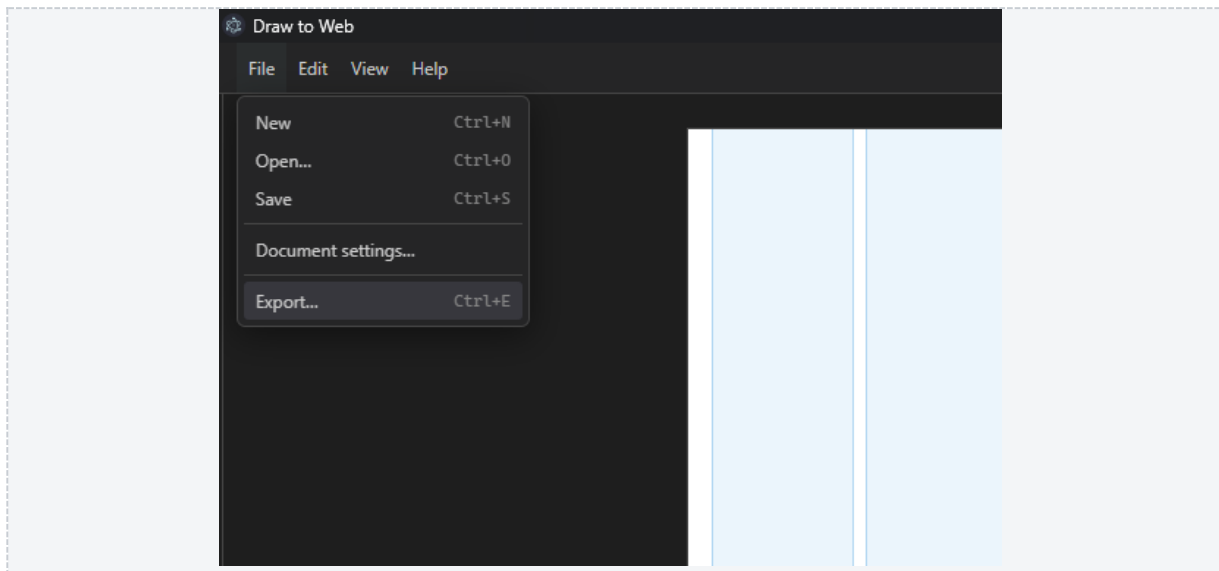


Figure 5. The File menu open, showing New, Open, Save, Document settings, and Export

4.2 Adding elements to the page

Everything on your page is added from the Insert sidebar on the left. There are three tabs:

- **Sections** — large, ready-made building blocks such as a hero banner or a footer.
- **Components** — smaller ready-made pieces such as a card or a navigation bar.
- **Elements** — the basic blocks: Container, Text, Image, Button, Link, Icon, List, and Divider.

Add an element by dragging

1. Open the tab you want (Sections, Components, or Elements).
2. Press and hold on a card, then drag it over the canvas.
3. Release the mouse over the area where you want it. A highlighted outline shows where it will land.

Tip: Use the search box at the top of the sidebar to find a block by name.

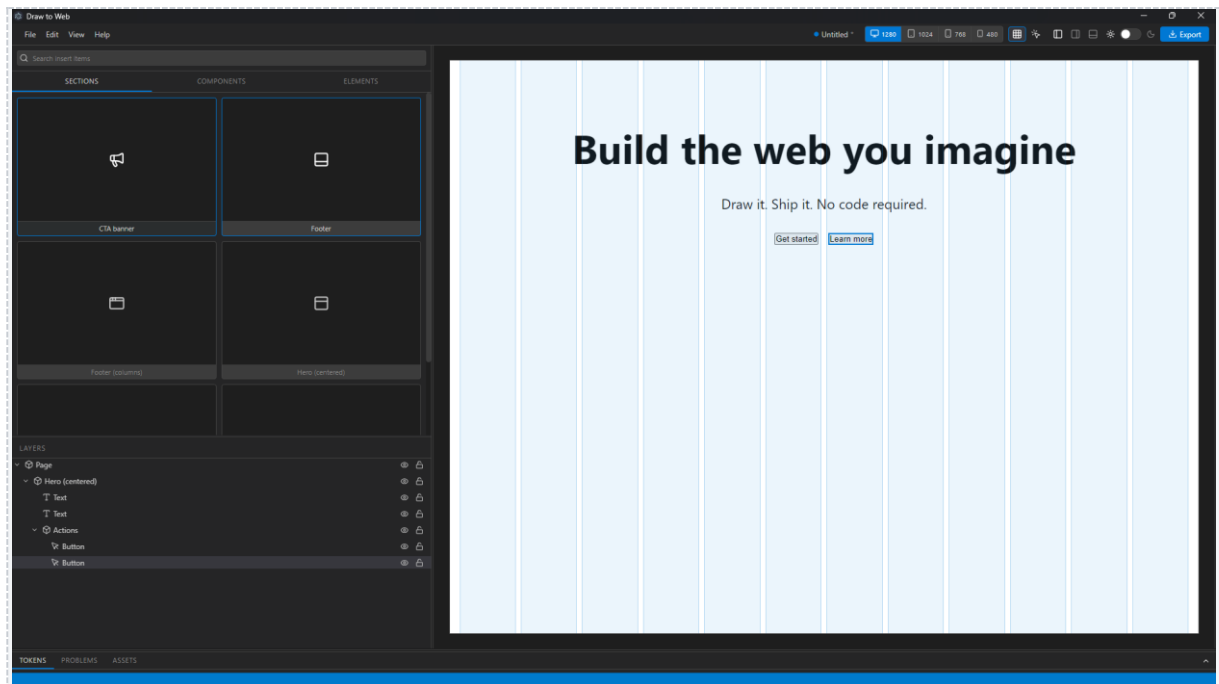


Figure 6. Dragging an element card from the sidebar onto the canvas

4.3 Selecting elements

- **Single click** an element to select it.
- **Shift-click** or **Ctrl-click** to add more elements to the selection (or remove one).
- **Click and drag on an empty area** to draw a selection box around several elements at once.
- **Click in the Layers panel** to select an item there; the canvas and panels stay in sync.

The selected element is outlined on the canvas, and its controls appear in the Properties panel.

4.4 Moving and reordering

Reorder within a container

1. Press and hold an element on the canvas.
2. Drag it above or below its neighbors and release to drop it in the new position.

Change stacking order

Right-click an element to open its menu, then choose:

- **Bring to front / Bring forward** (shortcut `]`) to move it later in the order.
- **Send backward / Send to back** (shortcut `[`) to move it earlier.

Nudge with the keyboard

1. Select an element.
2. Press an arrow key to nudge it by 1 pixel, or hold Shift and press an arrow key to move 10 pixels.

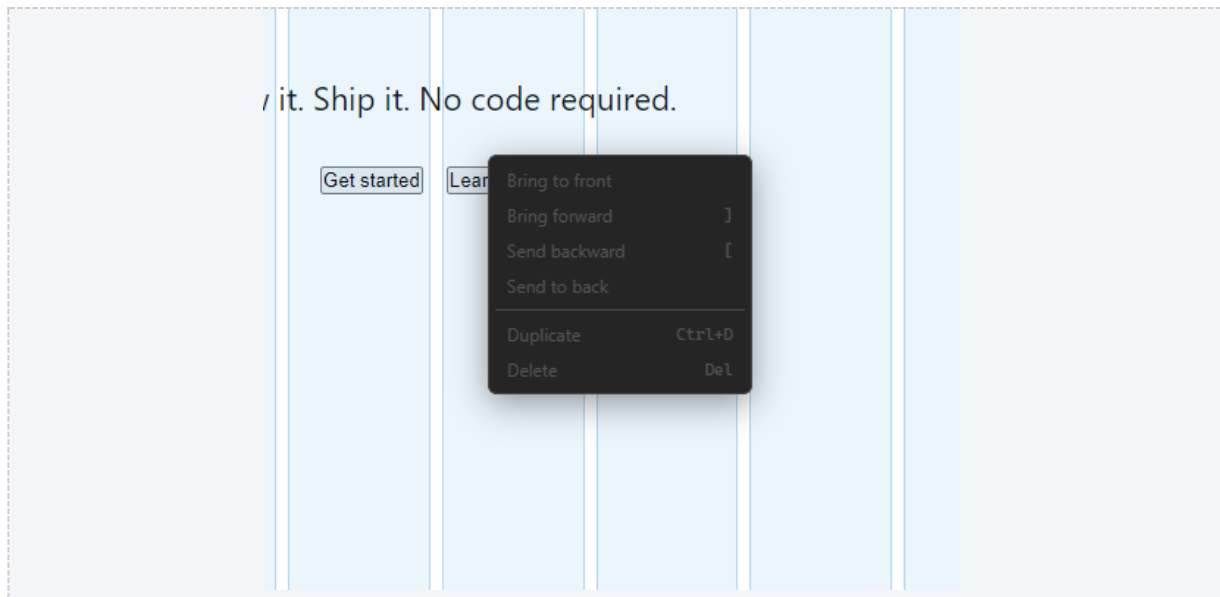


Figure 7. The right-click context menu with order and edit commands

4.5 Resizing

Select an element, then in the Properties panel use the Layout or Size controls:

- **Hug** makes the element only as wide as its contents.
- **Fill** makes it stretch to the full width available.
- **Fixed** lets you type an exact width.
- **Width, Height, Max width** fields accept values such as 320px or 100%.

4.6 Editing text

Edit the words

1. Double-click a text element on the canvas.
2. Type your text. Press Escape to cancel, or click elsewhere to keep the change.

Style the text

With a text element selected, open the Typography section in the Properties panel to set:

- Font family, font size, and weight.
- Line height and letter spacing.
- Alignment (left, center, right, justify).
- Decoration (underline or strikethrough), transform (uppercase/capitalize), and italic style.
- Text color, with a contrast check (see “Colors”).

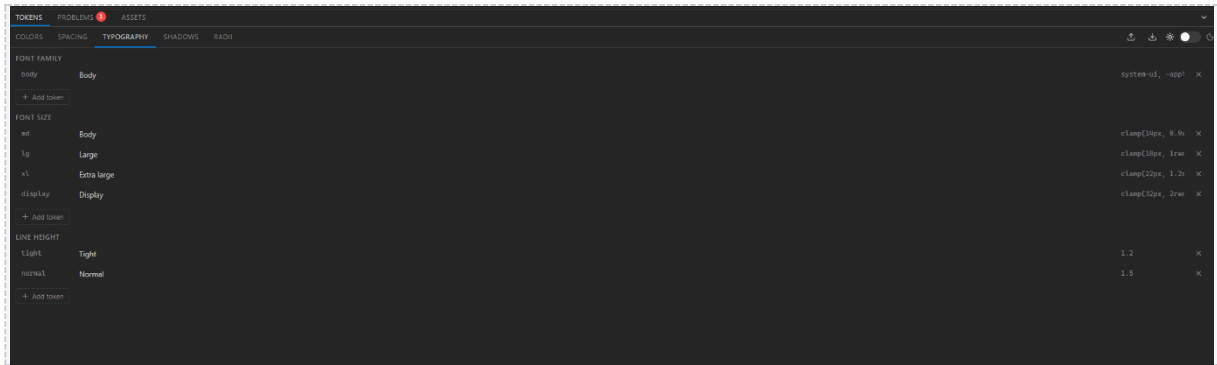


Figure 8. The Typography controls in the Properties Panel

4.7 Colors and fill

Color controls appear for text color and for an element's background (Fill).

1. Select an element and open the Fill or Typography section.
2. Click the color swatch to open the color picker and choose a color.
3. Watch the contrast badge: it shows whether text is easy to read against its background. Use the AA / AAA button to switch the strictness of the check.
4. To reuse a saved color instead, click the link button next to the control and pick a colour token (see "Design tokens").

4.8 Layout and spacing

For a container (a box that holds other elements), the Layout section controls how its contents are arranged:

- **Direction** — arrange children in a row or a column.
- **Gap** — the space between children.
- **Main axis / Cross axis** — how children align along and across the direction.
- **Padding** — inner space on the top, right, bottom, and left.

The Spacing section (for any element) sets Padding (inner space) and Margin (outer space) on all four sides.

4.9 Design tokens (reusable styles)

Tokens are named values — colors, spacing sizes, fonts, shadows, and corner radii — that you define once and reuse everywhere. Change a token, and everything using it updates at once. Tokens live in the Tokens tab of the bottom panel.

Add or edit a token

1. Open the bottom panel and select the Tokens tab.
2. Choose a category: Colors, Spacing, Typography, Shadows, or Radii.
3. Edit a value directly in its row, or click Add token / Add color to create a new one.

Use a token on an element

1. Select an element and find a color, spacing, or font control in the Properties panel.

2. Click the link button beside the control.
3. Search and pick the token. To go back to a one-off value, click the link button again and choose Unlink.

Import / export tokens: Use the upload and download buttons in the Tokens panel header to save your token set to a file or load one in.

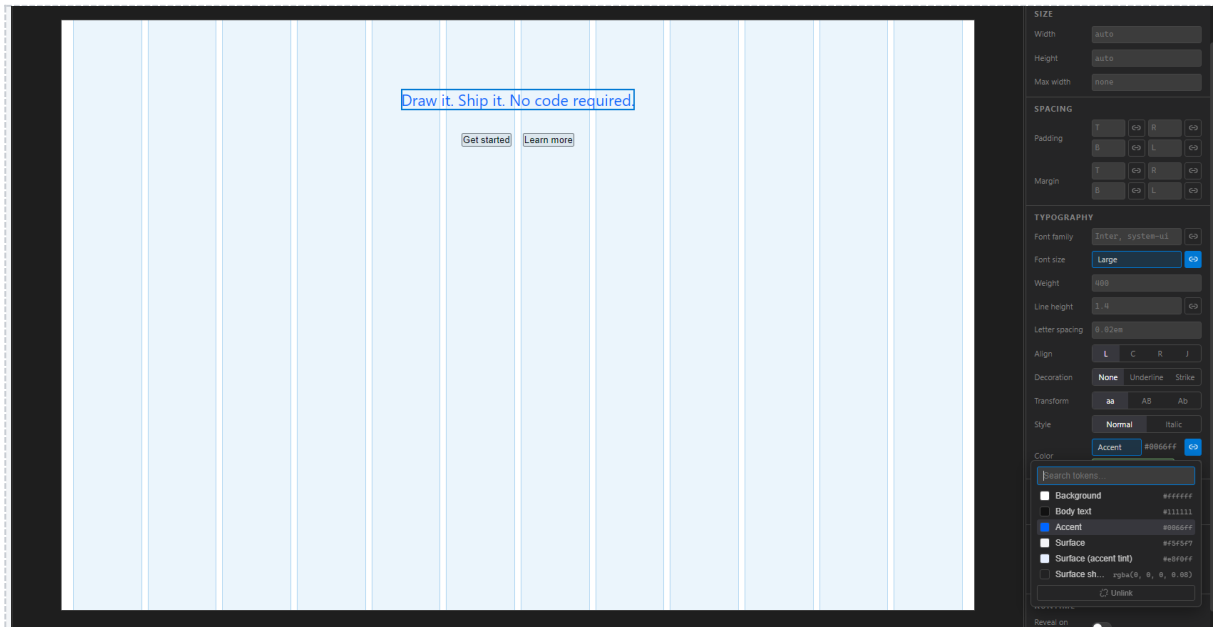


Figure 10. The Tokens panel with a colour token selected

4.10 Responsive design (screen sizes)

Use the breakpoint switcher in the toolbar to design for different screens: Desktop (1280), Tablet (1024), Mobile (768), and Small (480).

1. Click a breakpoint button (for example, Mobile).
2. The canvas resizes to that width.
3. Adjust the selected element's settings. Changes you make here apply only to that size; the Desktop values stay intact.

A banner at the top of the Properties panel reminds you which size you are editing, and a small badge marks each value that has a size-specific override.

4.11 Interactive states (hover, focus, active)

Elements can look different when a visitor hovers over, focuses, or presses them. The Default / Hover / Focus / Active tabs at the top of the Properties panel let you style each of these states.

1. Select an element.
2. Click the Hover (or Focus, or Active) tab.
3. Change any setting — the change applies only to that state.
4. Return to Default to confirm the normal appearance is unchanged.

A banner shows which state you are editing, and a small H/F/A badge marks each value you have customized for that state. Use the hover-preview button in the toolbar to see hover styling applied across the whole page at once.

4.12 Animations and scroll reveals

The Animation section in the Properties panel adds movement to an element:

1. Select an element and open the Animation section.
2. Choose a keyframe effect (such as fadeUp, fadeIn, scaleIn, slideLeft, pulse, or shimmer).
3. Optionally set a duration and a delay.

Turn on Reveal on scroll (in the Runtime section) to make an element animate into view as the visitor scrolls down. Motion is automatically reduced for visitors who prefer reduced motion.

4.13 Images and assets

Add an image

1. Add an Image element from the sidebar, or select an existing one.
2. In the Properties panel's Image section, click the upload area or drag an image file onto it (or paste an external web address).
3. Type a short description in the Alt text field so the image is accessible to screen-reader users. (Leave it empty only for purely decorative images.)

Manage uploaded images

The Assets tab in the bottom panel lists every image you have uploaded, with a thumbnail, its size, and how many places use it. Deleting an image that is still in use shows a warning first.

4.14 Layers: organize, rename, hide, and lock

The Layers panel (left sidebar, below Insert) lists every item on your page as a tree.

- **Select** — click a layer to select it on the canvas.
- **Expand / collapse** — click the arrow beside a container to show or hide its contents.
- **Rename** — double-click a layer's name and type a new one.
- **Hide** — click the eye icon to hide an element on the canvas; click again to show it. Hidden items do not appear on the canvas but remain in the project.
- **Lock** — click the lock icon to protect an element from being selected, moved, or edited on the canvas. Unlock it from the Layers panel at any time.

4.15 Grouping

1. Select two or more elements that share the same parent.
2. Press Ctrl+G to wrap them in a new group (a container).
3. To undo this, select the group and press Ctrl+Shift+G to ungroup.

4.16 Copy, paste, duplicate, and delete

- **Copy / Paste** — Ctrl+C then Ctrl+V.

- **Duplicate** — Ctrl+D makes an immediate copy next to the original.
- **Delete** — select one or more elements and press Delete (or Backspace).

4.17 Undo and redo

Made a mistake? Press Ctrl+Z to undo, and Ctrl+Shift+Z to redo. You can also use Undo and Redo in the Edit menu. Every change you make is a single undo step.

4.18 Preview helpers: grid and hover

- **Grid overlay** — the grid button in the toolbar shows a 12-column guide over the canvas to help you line things up. This setting is saved with the project.
- **Hover preview** — the hover button shows every element in its hover state so you can review hover styling without pointing at each one.

4.19 Light and dark theme

Use the theme toggle in the toolbar (or the Tokens panel) to switch the preview between light and dark. This lets you check both color schemes. The theme your visitors first see is set under Document settings → Meta and Export options.

4.20 Document settings

Open File → Document settings... to configure project-wide options across five tabs:

- **Meta** — page title, description, language, author, and canonical web address (used by search engines and social sharing).
- **Schema.org** — structured-data type (Person, Organization, or Website) and a name, which helps search engines understand your page.
- **Runtime** — turn on optional interactive behaviors: theme toggle, scroll-spy navigation, smooth scroll, mobile menu, nav-on-scroll styling, scroll reveals, animation gating, and terminal typing. With all off, the exported site contains no JavaScript.
- **A11y** — choose the accessibility contrast target (AA or the stricter AAA).
- **Variables** — define reusable text values. Type {{name}} in your text or fields, and the value is substituted when you export.

4.21 Checking your page (Problems panel)

The Problems tab in the bottom panel continuously checks your page and lists errors, warnings, and information notes — for example, an image missing its description or text with low contrast.

1. Open the bottom panel and select the Problems tab.
2. Click any issue to jump straight to the element it refers to.
3. Where a quick fix is available, click the Fix button to apply it automatically.

Important: If there are blocking errors, the Export button is disabled until they are resolved. This keeps your published site accessible and valid.

4.22 Live preview

Choose View → Live Preview... (or press Ctrl+Shift+P) to open your page in a separate preview window that reflects your current design. It is a quick way to see the page on its own, away from the editor.

4.23 Exporting your website

When your page is ready, export it as a complete set of website files.

1. Click the Export button in the toolbar (or choose File → Export..., or press Ctrl+E).
2. In the Export options dialog, set a filename for the ZIP file.
3. Choose the default theme (Auto, Light, or Dark).
4. Turn options on or off: Minify output (smaller files), Inline JavaScript, Self-host fonts (for offline use), and Source comments.
5. Click Export. A progress label shows each stage (validating, generating, optimizing images, minifying, bundling, and saving).
6. When it finishes, you will have a ZIP file containing your ready-to-publish website.

Note: Export is blocked while the Problems panel shows errors. Fix them first, then export.

4.24 If the project changes outside the editor

If the open project file is changed by another program, a dialog appears offering two choices: Reload from disk (load the external version — this clears your undo history) or Keep my changes (ignore the external change; your next save overwrites it).

5. Tips and Keyboard Shortcuts

5.1 Helpful tips

- Use tokens for colors and spacing so a single change updates the whole page.
- Check the Problems panel often — fixing issues early keeps export available.
- Design at Desktop first, then refine Tablet and Mobile.
- Add clear alt text to every meaningful image.
- Save regularly with Ctrl+S; the dot beside the project name shows unsaved changes.

5.2 Keyboard shortcuts

Open Help → Keyboard shortcuts... at any time to see this list inside the app.

Action	Shortcut
New project	Ctrl+N
Open project	Ctrl+O
Save	Ctrl+S
Save as	Ctrl+Shift+S
Export	Ctrl+E
Undo	Ctrl+Z
Redo	Ctrl+Shift+Z
Copy	Ctrl+C
Paste	Ctrl+V
Duplicate	Ctrl+D
Delete selection	Delete or Backspace
Select all in current section	Ctrl+A
Group selection	Ctrl+G
Ungroup	Ctrl+Shift+G
Nudge 1 pixel	Arrow keys
Nudge 10 pixels	Shift + Arrow keys
Bring forward	]
Send back	[
Live preview	Ctrl+Shift+P

6. Troubleshooting and FAQ

The Export button is greyed out.

Your page has blocking errors. Open the Problems tab in the bottom panel, fix the listed errors (use the Fix buttons where offered), and the Export button becomes available again.

Export fails at the “Minifying” stage.

Try exporting again with the Minify output option turned off in the Export options dialog. If the problem persists, contact your administrator — it usually means the installed application is missing a required component.

I changed a hover/tablet value but the field looks unchanged.

Make sure you are on the correct tab (for states) or breakpoint (for sizes). Values you have not customized there are inherited from Default/Desktop and look the same until you change them. The banner and small badges show what you have overridden.

I can't click an element on the canvas.

It may be locked or hidden. Open the Layers panel and click the lock or eye icon for that item to unlock or show it.

My image does not appear.

Confirm you uploaded a file or entered a valid web address in the Image section, and that the image is not hidden in the Layers panel.

I lost my place after the app closed.

Reopen your project. The application keeps a periodic backup, so recent work is usually preserved.

Where are my exported files?

They are saved as a single ZIP file at the location you chose during export. Unzip it to find the website's HTML, CSS, image, and (if enabled) JavaScript files.

Does Draw-to-Web send my work online?

No. The application works entirely on your computer. Projects and exports stay local unless you share them yourself.